

🔗 Reflex trap words → reach for the "instead"	
confidence score / threshold routing	explicit criteria+examples, or a hard check
bigger / higher-tier model · larger context	restructure: decompose, structured data, reorder
more precise prose / numbered spec	concrete input→output examples
merge tools / routing classifier	fix the tool descriptions
PostToolUse undo after	PreToolUse deny (block before)
"system prompt: X is mandatory"	programmatic prerequisite / gate
/compact · /clear	context:fork or Task subagent
footnote discarded / keep higher-conf	surface both, mark unresolved
~/claude for shared work	commit to project .claude/
"batches finish in ~1h"	up to 24h; keep blocking work sync

🌱 Agentic architecture	
Wrong tool, thin desc. ✗ few-shot / classifier / merge	✓ rewrite descriptions <i>boundary vs sibling, sample query</i>
Wrong tool, desc already clear. ✗ add neg. examples	✓ keyword conditional in the system prompt <i>clue: desc isn't the cause</i>
Few-shot for tool pick. ✗ 10-15 clear / grouped	✓ 4-6 ambiguous cases + reasoning <i>model already nails clear ones</i>
Migration w/ unknowns. ✗ codemod / tests / module-by-module	✓ Plan mode, approve approach first <i>others miss the design-level bug</i>
Subagent output too big. ✗ summarizer / bigger ctx / vector db	✓ upstream returns structured data <i>fix at source, no extra hop</i>
Agents overlap. ✗ shared scratchpad / dedupe after	✓ coordinator partitions subtopics up front
Coverage gaps. ✗ blame synth/search agent	✓ coordinator decomposition too narrow
Worker dies silent. ✗ "all collected = ok" / abort	✓ require returned success per dispatched item <i>no result = fail</i>
Subagent error types. ✗ timeout & "0 results" both fail	✓ timeout=retry, 0-results=valid; recover transient locally
Conflicting data. ✗ keep higher-conf + footnote	✓ return both, mark unresolved, owner decides
Partial coverage. ✗ global preamble / soften all	✓ per-section confidence note
Escalate? ✗ angry / threat / multi-concern / contradiction	✓ only policy-interp gap OR dead-end (no route to act)
Destructive write. ✗ prompt "wait" / snapshot / revert	✓ approval checkpoint blocks the apply
Must-never (refund/credit/delete). ✗ session log / token / PostToolUse / guard clause	✓ PreToolUse deny OR read authoritative record <i>independent of model, before money moves</i>
Deterministic transform. ✗ temp-0 agent / regex / LSP	✓ codemod over the AST, run once <i>regex hits same-named local var</i>
Sequential indep. lookups. ✗ composite tool / speculative / max_tokens	✓ parallel tool_use blocks in one turn

🧠 Context & batch	
Batch fit? ✗ batch both / timeout-fallback / smaller batches	✓ sync if blocks merge-push-release OR human deadline; batch only unattended
Batch + tool loop. ✗ batch the whole exchange	✓ keep gathering sync, batch only the final self-contained call
Verbose discovery. ✗ /compact / multi-session / scratch-reload	✓ Explore subagent returns a summary
Lost in the middle. ✗ summarize-all / bigger model / rotate	✓ digest at start+end + headers; or verbatim quote per field
Critical fact compacted. ✗ keep numbers in summary / raise threshold / pin turn	✓ write to external/case record, prepend every turn
Cache read=0. ✗ 5-min TTL / workspace scope	✓ volatile id before breakpoint → move it after

📁 Claude Code config	
Team / clone-ready. ✗ ~/.claude / root commands/ / doc section	✓ commit .claude/commands/ or .claude/CLAUDE.md
Personal override of team skill. ✗ same name / override:true	✓ a NEW command name /my-x same name won't shadow
Skill won't auto-fire. ✗ phrasings in body / CLAUDE.md / few-shot	✓ user phrasings in the description frontmatter
Modular, always-on. ✗ rules/ + paths glob	✓ @import lines in CLAUDE.md <i>rules+paths loads only for matching files</i>
Path/file-type rules. ✗ CLAUDE.md sections	✓ .claude/rules/ + paths: glob
MCP creds, shared file. ✗ .env / :-default / op:// / user scope	✓ \${ENV_VAR} in committed .mcp.json + document it

📄 Prompt & output	
Structured output. ✗ "respond only JSON"+strip+retry / few-shot / temp 0	✓ forced tool_choice + input_schema, read tool_use <i>prefill { = smallest fix for preamble</i>
Force the tool. ✗ mark all fields required	✓ tool_choice forces the CALL
Missing field. ✗ drop from required / "none" token	✓ keep required, type ["string", "null"]
Schema-validate fail. ✗ separate reformat call / pre-normalize	✓ tool_result is_error:true, Claude reissues <i>only it has the source</i>
Self-review blind spot. ✗ self-critique prompt / extended thinking	✓ 2nd independent instance, no generator reasoning
Inconsistent severity. ✗ mapping table / relative-to-PR / reasoning-then-adjust	✓ explicit criteria + borderline anchor / fixed budget
False-positive noise. ✗ uniform cut / confidence display / slow few-shot	✓ disable noisy category, fix offline, restore
Prose reinterpreted each iter. ✗ more precise spec / parser first	✓ 2-3 input→output examples
Ambiguous multi-match. ✗ re-query filters / confirm the one picked	✓ list the matches, user picks, before acting
Hallucinated API names. ✗ typecheck+regen / dump SDK to CLAUDE.md	✓ fetch real signatures from MCP doc, just-in-time
CI accuracy gate. ✗ average / one field / vs last run	✓ gate on the MIN per-field rate
Scanned/low-quality docs. ✗ augment prompt / OCR→shared / pass label	✓ own path per stream; scans read the image